

by accessing the NG's properties in the context menu.

Overall, OE is more than adequate for most NG users. Familiarity is one of it's strongest assets.



You see your news in the good old OE interface

Thunderbird 2

A news account can be created in Thunderbird (TB) from the New Account link in the File menu. After server and user details are provided, the familiar TB interface is shown. The server is shown on the left panel. To get the NGs in it select it and use Subscribe link in the context menu. After the NGs are listed, you can search for interested NGs from the search box. There number of messages in the NG is not listed which is a disappointment. To subscribe to the NG, select it and click on the subscribe button. The NGs are listed under the server name in the left panel. Selecting the NG will cause the headers to be downloaded. A pop up will prompt you if the number of headers to be downloaded is huge. After the headers are listed, selecting them will automatically download the message body. Replying to and creating posts will launch the usual message creation window.

Message filters can be created and applied, just as in the case of e-mails.

To configure server level options, right click on the server name on the left panel and use the Properties link. The client behaviour can be modified from the Options link in the

Tools menu. Finer control can be exercised by accessing the Config Editor under the Advanced button. Tip: to quickly get to controls that pertain to NGs use the search box.

Overall, TB offers all the required functionality to satisfy most NG users.

7.1.5 Conclusion

NGs offer a near-academic environment to indulge in serious discussion. When one tires of all the eye candy on a Web forum, and